

Chapter 40 - Xia Yangting

Feng Yue hadn't expected her first meeting with this Lawyer Xia to be so dramatic. However, precisely because the two had already met once before, their interaction now wasn't as stiff.

"Hello, Lawyer Xia. I'm Feng Yue." Feng Yue stood across from Xia Yangting, smiling as she extended her right hand.

Xia Yangting politely stood up and also extended her hand: "Hello, Miss Feng. Just call me by my name."

Having shared the experience of helping the girl together, the two had become somewhat closer.

Feng Yue curved her lips: "I didn't expect our first meeting today would be at a traffic light, Miss Xia."

"Perhaps it's fate." Xia Yangting smiled and nodded: "Miss Feng is more approachable than I imagined."

Feng Yue blinked mischievously: "Did Miss Xia think I was one of those arrogant, domineering socialite heiresses?"

Feng Yue had said this jokingly, but Xia Yangting straightforwardly nodded: "Yes. I was narrow-minded."

Feng Yue hadn't expected her to admit it so directly and couldn't help but laugh: "Ha! Miss Xia is also quite different from what I imagined."

"Oh? How so?"

"Hmm—probably my preconceived notions based on your profession. I thought lawyers should be rigorous, shrewd, decisive, capable, ruthless, and not talkative."

"Indeed, that's correct." Xia Yangting picked up her coffee and took a small sip: "That's most people's first impression of me."

"Ah, perhaps because we met beforehand, I don't think Miss Xia is like that. Instead, I think Miss Xia is a good person who's not very articulate?" Feng Yue pondered, then nodded.

This was probably the first time someone had used the words "good person" to describe Xia Yangting, which made her somewhat curious about Feng Yue.

Since middle school, when her body had grown tall and her features matured, combined with her somewhat dull personality, others' impressions of her were generally words like "difficult to get along with."

A good person who's not articulate.

This was the first time she had received such a description.

"Miss Xia is a very good person, so I can't deceive you. I'm a patient with an illness, and my little aunt doesn't know about this. I'm sorry for deceiving you, Miss Xia."

Xia Yangting was somewhat surprised but wasn't very angry.

Feng Yue's little aunt and her mother were card-playing friends. When the two elders chatted at the card table, her mother would talk about her lifelong matters. So when her mother told her to set aside an afternoon for a blind date, Xia Yangting was very resistant.

But she couldn't withstand her mother's daily nagging, pleading, and coercion. Finally, both retreated a step—regardless of how the meeting between her and Feng Yue went, her mother couldn't interfere with blind date matters anymore.

Xia Yangting herself hadn't wanted to come on this blind date and had originally planned to spend ten minutes in the coffee shop to resolve this matter. But because of the unexpected incident at the traffic light intersection, her inner resistance and dissatisfaction toward Feng Yue had largely dissipated, replaced by some curiosity.

What Feng Yue had just brought up, whether true or false, probably had the same fundamental intention as hers had been earlier.

They were both unwilling participants in this blind date. No, rather, they both hadn't come to this meeting with the purpose of blind dating.

So Xia Yangting didn't feel angry at all. After a moment of silence, she asked: "Is Miss Feng's illness very serious?"

Feng Yue propped her chin on one hand and thought: "It was very serious before—the kind that could be life-threatening. But I'm receiving proper treatment now, so there's nothing seriously wrong."

"That's good. I hope Miss Feng recovers soon."

"Thank you."

Feng Yue looked at Xia Yangting sitting across from her and asked with pursed lips: "Doesn't Miss Xia find it offensive that I said this?"

"Why would I think that?" Xia Yangting asked in return.

"It's probably very disrespectful to you." Feng Yue did feel somewhat guilty.

Xia Yangting shook her head, put down her coffee cup, and said seriously: "Elders' opinions aren't something we can easily refuse. If we're talking about disrespect, my earlier thoughts were the same as Miss Feng's. Before meeting Miss Feng, I had planned to use ten minutes to resolve today's blind date. That was probably very disrespectful to you too."

Looking at her, Feng Yue couldn't help but laugh again. She thought to herself that indeed, occasionally there would be people like Xia Yangting who were straightforward and direct. It wasn't that she didn't understand flexibility; she simply believed that speaking directly would be better and more convenient for future interactions.

"Since Miss Xia won't blame me, then I certainly won't blame you. It seems we're both fellow sufferers."

Xia Yangting curved her lips and nodded.

"So when Miss Xia said she wanted to resolve things here in ten minutes, do you have other matters afterward? If so, we can end here today."

Xia Yangting looked at her phone, then looked up and said: "That was my earlier thought. Now I neither have other matters nor such thoughts."

Feng Yue was puzzled: "Hm?"

"If it's convenient, may I invite Miss Feng to dinner?"

Xia Yangting looked very serious, so much so that Feng Yue thought she simply wanted to treat her to a meal.

"Uh, of course."

Xia Yangting nodded and took out her phone to make restaurant reservations: "Since Miss Feng is ill, are there any dietary restrictions?"

Feng Yue nodded and told her about foods she couldn't eat.

In the end, she somehow managed to score a dinner from Xia Yangting.

During this time, Feng Yue got up to use the restroom, and Xia Yangting waited for her in the coffee shop.

Not long after Feng Yue got up, Xia Yangting's WeChat notification sounded. She looked and saw it was from her mother.

It was asking how their meeting was going.

After thinking about it, Xia Yangting picked up her phone and called her mother. She preferred to explain things verbally.

"Hello, Mom."

"Baby, why are you calling me directly? Have you already separated? Didn't the meeting go well?" Xia's mother fired off questions as soon as she answered.

"I think speaking is clearer. We haven't separated yet. Miss Feng just went to the restroom. I think the meeting went very well." Xia Yangting answered her mother's questions one by one.

"That's good." Xia's mother breathed a sigh of relief: "So what do you think of Feng Yue?"

Xia Yangting paused and thought for two seconds. What did she think of Feng Yue? She seemed pretty good, at least she wasn't like what she had imagined. Instead, she was somewhat hard to figure out.

She didn't know if this counted as being satisfied, but at least she didn't dislike the time spent with Feng Yue.

Feng Yue was different from most people she had encountered. She was easy to understand yet hard to see through.

As a lawyer who had also minored in psychology in university, Xia Yangting could easily understand what kind of person someone was. In the legal world of judgment, she had seen too many ugly sides of human nature.

So Feng Yue was probably a bit cleaner than those people.

At least that's what Xia Yangting thought now.

So in Xia Yangting's mind, even if their blind date didn't go well, at least being friends with someone like Feng Yue wouldn't be bad.

Xia Yangting came back to her senses under her mother's urging and said flatly: "I had originally planned to resolve this matter quickly, but now I've already invited Miss Feng to dinner."

"Not bad, not bad! It seems you're quite satisfied with Feng Yue!" Xia's mother laughed heartily.

"Mm... probably."

"Alright, since you're satisfied, I won't disturb you two. Remember to see her home after dinner."

"Driving would cause traffic jams, so I took the subway here today." Meaning she had no means of transportation to see Feng Yue home; if she were to escort her, she would probably accompany her on the subway.

Xia's mother: ...

"Do as you like!" After saying this, Xia's mother quickly and decisively hung up.

Of course, in the end, the two had dinner together, and Feng Yue didn't let Xia Yangting see her home.

Their home directions were completely opposite. If she really let Xia Yangting accompany her on the subway to Songhe Bay and then take the subway back to her own home, Feng Yue would probably die of embarrassment.

However, after they separated, the two exchanged contact information, saying they could arrange meals when they had the chance.

Feng Yue was completely fine with making another friend, and she also thought Xia Yangting was quite easy to get along with.

Feng Yue was in a good mood. After exiting the subway station, she didn't rush home but went to browse the convenience store downstairs.

She bought a bunch of miscellaneous things, mainly ingredients for snacks she would make for the upcoming Golden Week trip, and some household items that were running low at home.

Before leaving, she also went to the cake shop to buy a small piece of cake.

She and Xia Yangting had eaten at a medicinal cuisine restaurant today. Although it wasn't unpalatable, her mouth felt bland afterward. Since she couldn't eat anything too spicy, she could only choose a not-too-sweet cake to adjust the taste.

So by the time Feng Yue pressed the building's door access button, it was almost nine o'clock. She took out her card as usual to open the elevator, preparing to go upstairs.

But when the elevator doors opened, she saw an extremely familiar figure standing inside.

Feng Yue looked at the woman standing inside and caught a whiff of heavy alcohol. Her expression suddenly darkened.

The other person also opened her eyes to look at her, obviously very surprised to see her at this time.

The two stood there quietly. Just as the elevator doors were about to close automatically, the person inside reached out to stop the doors.

At this moment, the building's access buzzer sounded again. A teenage girl entered from the entrance, carrying snacks bought from the supermarket.

Seeing that the elevator doors hadn't closed, the little girl hurried over. But when she reached Feng Yue's side and saw that she wasn't going in, she curiously asked: "Sister, aren't you going in?"

Feng Yue gritted her teeth and took a deep breath: "Let's go."

Then all three entered the elevator together.

The little girl got off on the tenth floor, leaving only Feng Yue and the woman reeking of alcohol, leaning against the elevator corner—Yan Lin.

Feng Yue stood very close to the elevator doors. Her hands hanging at her sides were tightly clenched, her eyes staring intently at the two adjacent floor numbers lit up on the elevator buttons.

"13, 14"

So the person who had bought Miss Li's apartment was Yan Lin.

She had persistently moved downstairs from her, right below her home.